

COVER STORY
US ELECTIONS

28 | Obama Revolution

He transcended race, gender, age and experience to become America's first Black president. Now Barack Obama must deliver the US out of its worst moment at home and abroad. Also, what Obama means for India.

NATION
POLL FUNDING

44 | Funds & Games

Political funding has always been a murky and unexplored area. It still is, as political parties file income tax returns with disclosures that are far from transparent. INDIA TODAY investigates.

STATES
ASSEMBLY POLLS

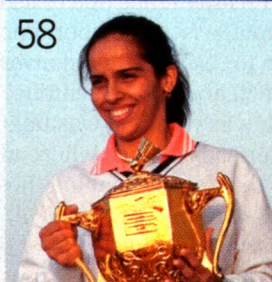
48 | Battle Begins

Voters will queue up at polling booths in Delhi, Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh, Jammu and Kashmir, Madhya Pradesh and Mizoram in Assembly polls staggered over the next few weeks which are seen as a prelude to Lok Sabha elections.

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STATES
ORISSA

54 | Copter Cabinet

It's one of India's poorest states but Orissa ministers prefer to shun terra firma and take to the skies to clock frequent flyer miles on public money.

PROFILE
SAINA NEHWAL

58 | Serving Smashes

The world junior badminton champion now dreams of a place among the top 10 and experts believe this fearless Hyderabad shuttler has what it takes to become world No. 1.

LEISURE
CINEMA

68 | Tiara Trio

They are opening movies, pushing brands, cherry picking projects and gracing glossy covers. They are the new queens of Bollywood.

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Jobs Today **80**

Take a look at the latest job offers in the Market.

Cover photograph by REUTERS